

and use an anti-virus. However, if you merely want to safely use your portable memory, use Process Explorer to halt the processes that were alerted by the process scan, and proceed by plugging in the portable storage device.

5.2 Securely carry personal passwords

There is a concept known as a “life password”, which is a common tendency amongst computer users. Most people use the same password for all the websites that they use, including forums, social networking sites, image hosting sites and for the whole host of services that Web 2.0 has to offer. This is actually a very risky thing to do, as if a single site gets compromised, or you are misled into signing up on a bogus website, all your accounts are compromised. Your e-mail account is a step away from your financial details, which are enough to scam you. Another, marginally more secure approach that people have is to use high-level passwords for the more sensitive sites, and low-level passwords for all the other websites that they frequent. This too, is not as secure as having a different password for different sites.

The total number of passwords a modern computer user has to keep track of, can quickly get very complicated and hard to manage. For this purpose, people use a password “safehouse”, such as KeyPass, to keep their passwords secure and available at any point of time. KeyPass stores all the passwords for all your accounts in one secure location. The passwords are stored in a database, for retrieval whenever necessary. KeyPass encrypts the files with the passwords that it stores, so it would take considerable time and effort to decrypt the password file, even if the attacker has a lot of computer resources at his disposal. It is possible to choose a combination of protection for your passwords, that all the present computing power allocated to cracking the encrypted text file for the rest of the lifetime of the universe would not be able to crack it. KeyPass is very secure, but the users will have to be careful of two things, the master password to access the password database, and the key file, if the user decides to make one. A keyfile is a block of randomly generated data, that is used to codify the passwords, and to